Product Requirements Document - Template

> **About this template**
>
> A PRD defines what is being built in enough detail to be testable, without prescribing how to build it. It is the authoritative reference for product intent: the capabilities the module must deliver, the behaviors it must exhibit, the constraints it must respect, and the criteria by which success is measured.
>
> A PRD typically defines a single Module: a skill, a service, a discrete product unit.
>
> Owned by the PM for the module. Read by engineering, design, QA, and any team whose work depends on the module. Engineers, designers, and agentic coding tools like Claude Code should be able to read this document alongside a technical design and know exactly what "done" looks like for each capability.
>
> A well-written PRD is short because its upstream documents carry the context. It references the Product Strategy for the WHY but does not restate it. It feeds into the technical design but does not constrain it. A PRD that balloons into executive summaries and strategic framing is usually a symptom of missing documents above it in the hierarchy.
>
> This document is durable substrate during planning. It moves through discovery and locks at dev start. Subsequent changes are tracked as explicit amendments. Once execution begins, Jira owns current state. The PRD remains the reference for what was agreed and why.
>
> Update the PRD when product decisions change. If a capability is added, removed, or redefined, the PRD changes. If the technical approach shifts during build, the PRD does not.
>
> For the larger framework this document sits inside, see the Product Development Hierarchy and Document Framework.

[Product / Feature Name] — Product Requirements Document

Author: [PM Name] **Last Updated:** [Date] **Status:** Draft | In Review | Approved | Superseded

References

Document	Link
Product Strategy	[Link to strategy doc that covers the why, opportunity, and high-level concept]
Design / UX	[Figma or design tool link] — Status: Not Started / In Progress / Final
Implementation Plan	[Link, once created]
Jira Board	[Link to the Jira board or epic for this effort, once project kicks off]

Approvals

Role	Name	Date
Product Owner		
Engineering Lead		
Design Lead		
[Stakeholder]		

Product Hierarchy

[LINK] - See Link for Details

Level	Name
Solution	[e.g., Patient Engagement Solution]
Product	[e.g., Care Agent]
Module	[e.g., On-Demand Documents Skill — this is what the PRD defines]

Overview

A concise summary of what this product or feature is. Two to three sentences maximum. State what it does for the user, not how it works. This section should be scannable by an executive or a new team member and immediately convey what's being built.

Strategic Context

Do not restate the product strategy here. Instead, briefly note which specific opportunity or initiative from the strategy document this PRD addresses. One short paragraph.

Initiative / Opportunity: [Name or identifier from the strategy doc] **Target Outcome:** [The business or user outcome this feature is intended to drive, stated in one sentence]

Target Users

Identify who this feature is for. Be specific about user segments, roles, or personas. If multiple user types interact with the feature, describe each and how their needs differ.

For each user type, state:

- Who they are (role, context, relationship to the product)
- What they need from this feature
- What a successful outcome looks like for them

Capabilities

This is the core of the PRD. Each capability is a set of features that together solve a problem or serve a specific need within this module. Capabilities are stated from the user's perspective: observable and testable behaviors that describe what the system does, not how it does it. Each capability contains the discrete features that enable it, which map directly to Jira issues at the ticket level.

Capability 1: [Name]

Description: [What the system does, stated as a user-observable behavior. One to three sentences.]

User Story: As a [user type], I [action] so that [outcome].

Behavioral Rules:

- [Specific rule governing how this capability behaves in context]
- [Another rule. Be precise. These are product decisions, not engineering decisions.]
- [Include conditional logic where it exists: "If X, then Y. If Z, then W."]

Edge Cases:

- [What happens when expected data is missing?]
- [What happens when the user's request is ambiguous?]
- [What happens when multiple valid options exist?]
- [What happens when the user doesn't have permission or access?]

Acceptance Criteria:

- [Stated as user-observable outcomes. "The patient receives only the requested document, not the full package."]
- [Each criterion should be independently verifiable.]
- [Avoid technical assertions. "The API returns a 200" is not an acceptance criterion. "The patient sees their document within 3 seconds of verification" is.]

Features:

The discrete deliverables that enable this capability. Each feature maps to one or more Jira issues at the ticket level.

Feature	Description
[e.g., Document Type Selection]	[e.g., Patient can browse and select from available document types for their visit]
[e.g., Document Delivery]	[e.g., Selected document is rendered and delivered as an individual PDF via secure link]

Capability 2: [Name]

[Same structure as above: Description, User Story, Behavioral Rules, Edge Cases, Acceptance Criteria, and Features. Repeat for each capability.]

Constraints

Constraints are non-negotiable requirements that any valid implementation must satisfy. These are not implementation decisions. They are boundary conditions imposed by regulation, platform, security, data sensitivity, or business rules.

Regulatory & Compliance

- [e.g., All interactions involving PHI must comply with HIPAA privacy and security rules.]
- [e.g., Payment processing must comply with PCI-DSS requirements.]

Data & Privacy

- [e.g., Patient identity must be verified before any protected data is exposed.]
- [e.g., The system must not store or log raw payment credentials.]

Platform & Integration

- [e.g., Must integrate with the existing EMR system for patient and visit data.]
- [e.g., Must operate within the existing authentication framework.]
- [State integration points as requirements, not as technical specifications. "Must integrate with the EMR" is a constraint. "Must call the /api/v2/encounters endpoint" is implementation detail that belongs in the implementation plan.]

Performance

- [e.g., Primary user actions must complete within 3 seconds under normal load.]
- [e.g., System must support X concurrent users without degradation.]

Accessibility

- [e.g., Must meet WCAG 2.1 AA compliance.]
- [e.g., Must be usable on mobile devices with screen readers.]

User Journeys

Describe the key user journeys end to end. These are narrative walkthroughs, not flowcharts or state diagrams. They should illustrate how a user moves through the feature in a realistic scenario. Include enough detail that someone unfamiliar with the product can understand the experience, but do not describe UI layouts or technical behavior.

Journey 1: [Scenario Name]

Actor: [User type] **Trigger:** [What initiates this journey] **Preconditions:** [What must be true before this journey begins]

Flow:

1. [Step 1: What the user does or experiences]
2. [Step 2: How the system responds]
3. [Continue through the complete journey]

Outcome: [What the user has accomplished at the end]

Journey 2: [Scenario Name]

[Same structure. Include journeys for primary use cases, secondary use cases, and at least one error or exception scenario.]

Success Metrics

Define how success will be measured. Separate metrics into tiers so the team knows what matters most and what's being monitored for side effects.

Primary Metrics

Metrics that directly measure whether the feature achieved its intended outcome. These determine go/no-go for broader rollout.

Metric	Baseline	Target	Measurement Method
[e.g., Document request completion rate]	[Current state or N/A if new]	[Target value]	[How it will be measured]

Exit Criteria: [What has to be true for this feature to be considered successful? Be specific. "Completion rate exceeds 80% over a 30-day measurement window" is an exit criterion. "Patients like it" is not.]

Secondary Metrics

Metrics that provide additional signal about feature performance but are not sufficient on their own to determine success or failure.

Metric	Baseline	Target	Measurement Method

Monitoring Metrics

Metrics watched for unintended negative effects. No target required, but define thresholds that would trigger investigation.

Metric	Current Baseline	Alert Threshold
[e.g., Support call volume related to documents]	[Current value]	[Value that would indicate a problem]

Scope Boundaries

In Scope

- [Capabilities and behaviors this PRD covers]

Out of Scope

- [Related capabilities that are explicitly not part of this effort. Be specific about why: deferred to a future phase, owned by a different team, or intentionally excluded.]

Dependencies

- [Other teams, systems, or deliverables this feature depends on. State the dependency, not the technical integration. "Requires patient identity data from the EMR" is a dependency. "Requires the /patient/lookup API to be deployed to production" is an implementation dependency that belongs in the implementation plan.]

Open Questions

Unresolved product decisions that need answers before or during build. Each question should identify who owns the decision and what the impact of the decision is on the capabilities defined above.

Question	Owner	Impact	Status
[e.g., Should family members be able to	[PM / Stakeholder]	[Affects Capability 3 scope and	Open / Resolved

request documents on behalf of a patient?]		identity verification rules]	

Revision History

Date	Author	Change Summary
04/24/2026	Ian Lyman	Created

This PRD defines what is being built. For strategic context, technical approach, design artifacts, and project tracking, see the References table at the top of this document. Once the project is in progress, Jira is the source of truth for current state of work. This document remains the reference for product intent and capability requirements.